SARABANDE

How to: Write A Pitch Deck

with

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@sarabandefoundation @bluegaydon @everymancinema @botivodrinks @hennessy #sarabandefoundation #sarabandeevents

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What we will cover

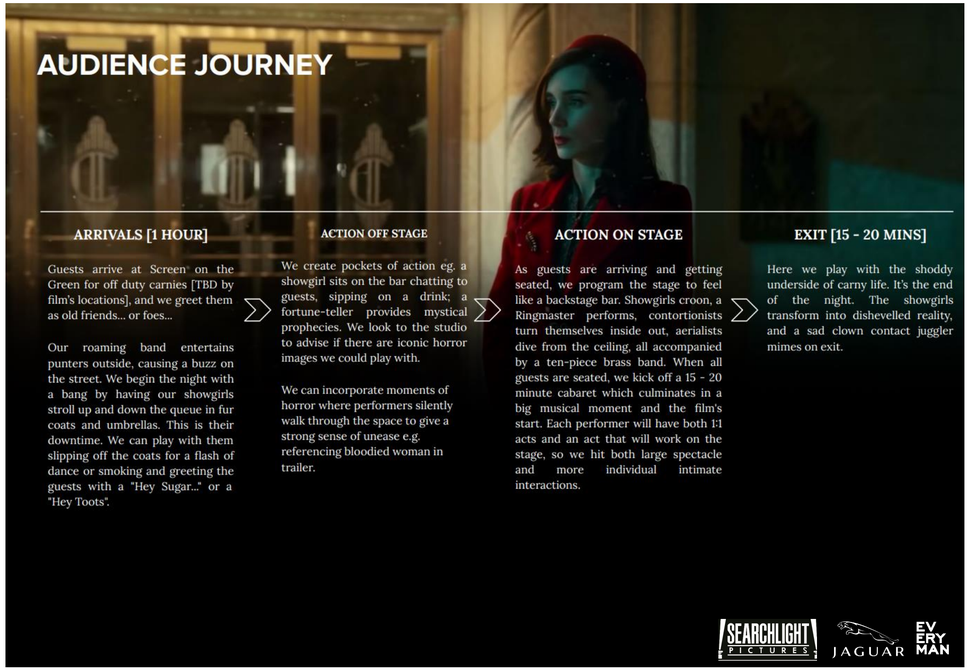
- Introductions
- What is the role of a pitch deck?
- Before you start!
- Structuring a winning deck
- Examples *(not included in this handout)*
- Which softwares should you use?
- Pitch deck etiquette
- What you should avoid
- Beyond the deck

Introductions

What is the role of a pitch deck?

- A practical tool for creative storytelling and bringing a creative idea to life
- You are transporting the reader into your world / your personal brand
- You are aiming to generate an emotional response
  - The deck should visually inspire, but also be <u>very clear</u>





Before you start!

- Identify which software application you will be using (we will discuss different options in more detail later)
- How will this deck be received / presented?
  - Will this be in-person?
  - Are you pitching over Zoom?
  - Are you sending it across via email?
- Identify what the recipient's business needs are + make sure that you fully understand the brief

Structuring a winning deck

Front Cover

Artist bio / CV of shows + achievements

The Brief

How you fit their brief
Shared values, vision / mission

The Idea

Immerse your reader

The Idea Explained

Answer the 5 W's
Reinforce shared values, vision / mission

Mock Ups / Moodboard

Renders, photoshop in location
Be realistic

Past Projects + Collaborations

Production Timeline

Install considerations (if applicable)

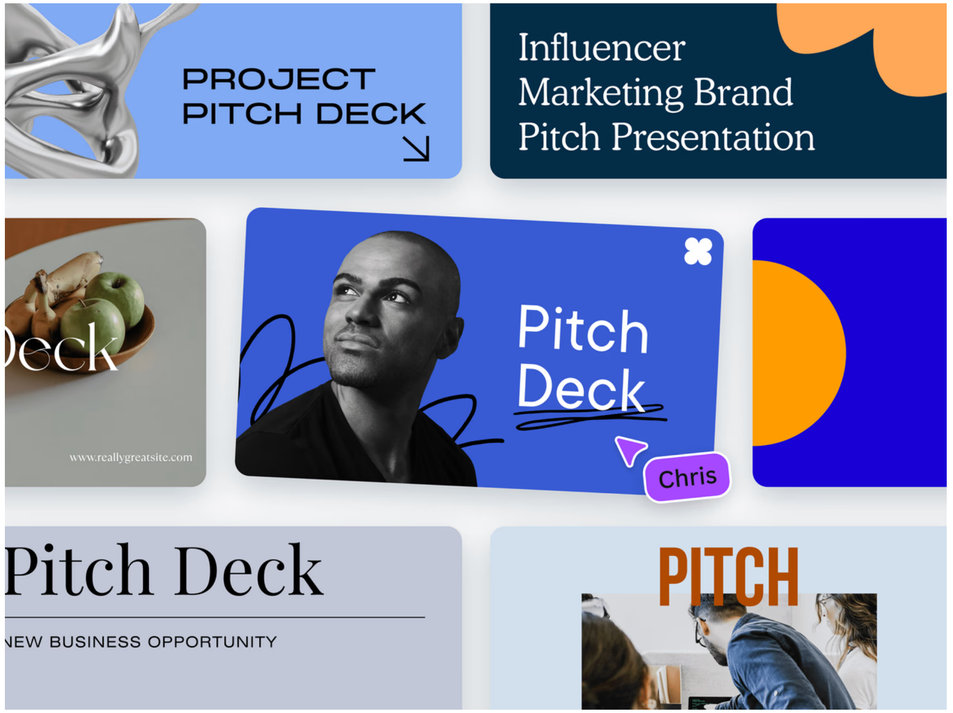
Budget

Overall budget should include your artist fee + all production costs, install, travel, etc
Be thorough

Closing / Thank you slide

Which softwares should you use?

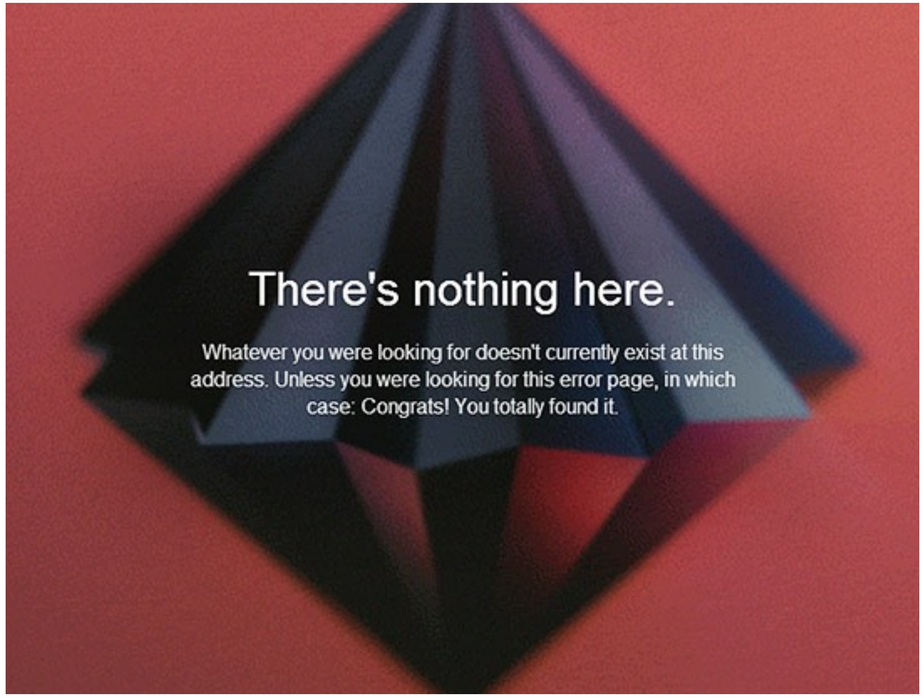
- If you're in a time crunch, you should be using a software that you know well and can produce something polished with
- Powerpoint / Keynote / Google Slides / InDesign / Canva / Pitch
- Pitch deck data – with apps like DocSend (free 14 day trial, then from £12 per month) you can:
    - See who has actually opened the file and looked at it + for how long
    - See how many times the deck was opened
    - Understand how to optimise your deck (change/remove slides that people spend the least time on)
    - See + gently chase if the deck was left unopened
- Videos – they're a great way to communicate information quickly + with impact
    - Other than your own videos, you can download footage that showcases your work with apps like Toolzin



Canva, 2025

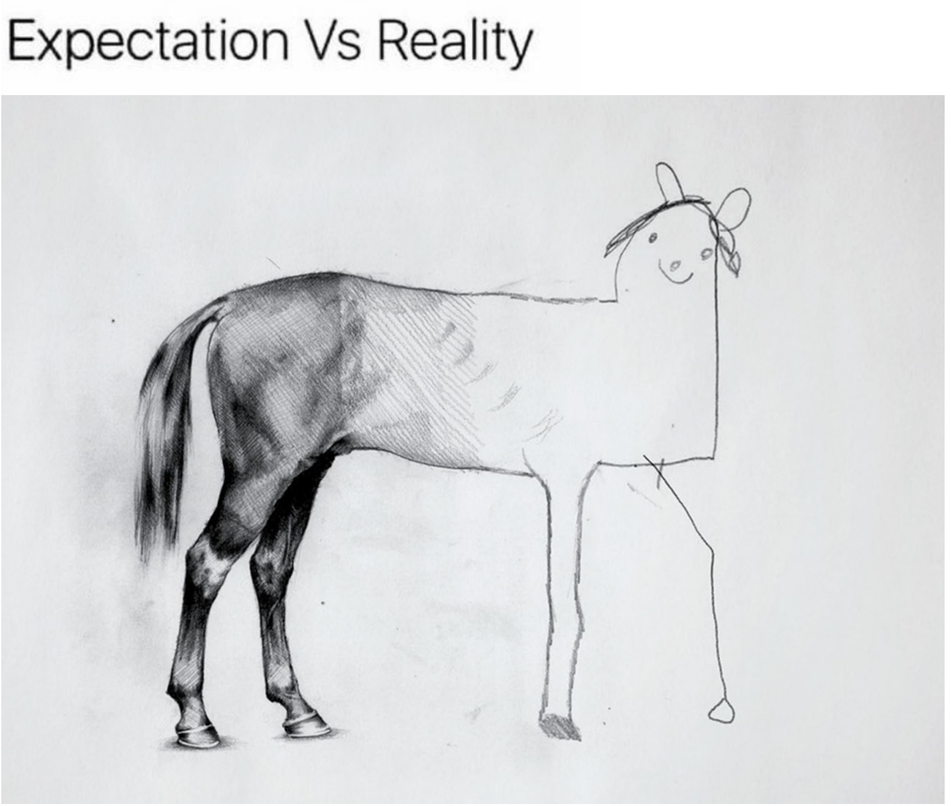
Pitch deck etiquette

- Aim to take reader on a visual journey!
- Your headlines / slide titles need to be super clear – the reader must know exactly what that specific section of your deck is about.
- Use clear, concise and inclusive copy
- Be careful what you include in your moodboards / as reference imagery – make it very clear if an asset you've used isn't yours
    - Be aware that using other people's imagery can lead to your reader expecting the same level of production
- Video files – check that the settings are what you need them to be – autoplay / loop / sound on/off
- Make sure the file you are sending across isn't huge – compress your PDF
- Make sure your hyperlinks are accessible (no passwords or paywalls) + relevant. Use specific, meaningful text that conveys the link's purpose.
- Make sure your titles, text + visuals are properly and consistently aligned



What you should avoid

- Reams of lofty, waffling ‘conceptual language’
- Repeating the idea in different way
- Overpromising – be realistic about your output and what you can offer
- Impossibly large files – you only have a few seconds to make a good impression; make it easy as possible to view / share.
- Inaccessible content – make sure ‘share’ settings are up to date + content isn’t restricted by login / paywalls
- Sending without checking everything works / there are no typos – send the deck to yourself, a colleague or a friend to check
- Overwriting – save as versions (V1, V2, etc) in case clients ask you to go back to your original pitch



Beyond the deck

- Your / your brand's online profile should be up to date + align with what is being said in your deck – website, LinkedIn, Instagram
- Do your research! What has the brand recently been involved with? What projects have they done? Who have they partnered with in the past? Brand news = conversation starters
- Immerse yourself in their world
    - Physical venues – go to their flagship store + explore for a couple hours, take notes, observe their audience/clientele (what is the age range, what are they buying …)
- Look beyond your pitch / concept bubble
- Look for opportunities to pitch – open calls, awards, prizes



Everyman